

# Use the Checklist. Connection Beats Technique.

*Visual reference cards from the Thursday 14 May session led by director Corie Dawson. Use alongside the Session 1–5 toolkits. Print, pin to your wall, or keep on your desk.*

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All five resources per session, every time. The book has the answers.
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Predict the objection and dispose of it before they take a position.
- 04 Mirror their language back**  
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It's what lets you survive your own mistakes.
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"Just looking" → pattern interrupt. The conversation runs differently from there.
- 09 Daily mindset card**  
Print and pin. Read every morning.

# Use the materials, or wing it

Each training session produces five resources, sequenced deliberately. Skipping any of them leaves gaps that show up on real pitches.

## EVERY SESSION GIVES YOU FIVE RESOURCES

*Complete all five before pitching anything related to the session topic.*

**01****DEBRIEF**

Read it.

*10 min*

**02****TOOLKIT**

Reference it.

*5 min*

**03****PODCAST**

Listen to it.

*20 min*

**04****PRESENTATION**

Watch it.

*15 min*

**05****QUIZ**

Get tested.

*10 min*

### THE MINIMUM BAR

- Complete all five resources for the most recent two sessions before any new pitch.
- Quiz below 80% = the material didn't stick. Re-read. Re-take.
- Treat the toolkit PDF like a pre-flight checklist. Walk through it every pitch.
- Don't wing it. You have the answers — open the book.

### QUOTE

*"I keep the checklist in front of me every time I fly. I know what's on it better than you do — and I still pull it out. Why? So I don't make mistakes. That's why the checklist exists."*

# Every pitch is the same pitch

Seven steps. The same sequence on every call. Don't reinvent — execute.

**1****CALCULATE AFFORDABILITY**

Service business = staff × \$100k. Trade business = staff × \$100k × 3.

**2****BREAK IT DOWN WEEKLY**

Annual turnover ÷ 50 weeks = weekly value. Sets the price anchor.

**3****READ THEIR SITUATION**

Growing? Holding steady? Contracting? Match your energy to their reality.

**4****BUILD THE PITCH FROM THEIR WORDS**

Use their exact language. Mirror their goal back through your product.

**5****PITCH HIGH. SHOW THE STACK**

Three priced options. Let them choose. Don't self-select downwards.

**6****DIAGNOSTIC IF THEY HESITATE**

Match → out of 10 → surface the real reason → isolate the variable → hard close.

**7****ASSUME THE CLOSE**

Skip “would you like to proceed?” Go straight to deposit and scheduling.

**THE PRINCIPLE**

Reps fail when they treat every pitch as a new problem. Run the sequence. Every prospect. Every time. The variation lives in the customer's words — not in your method.

# Block the exits — the abalone rule

Once a prospect takes a verbal position, they're locked. The play is to prevent the position from forming.

## THE ABALONE PRINCIPLE

*An abalone suckers down to the rock when it senses you coming. A crane can't move it. Prospects work the same way: once they sucker down on a position ("I don't want too many leads," "I need to think about it"), they're fixed. Prevent the position from forming.*

### TOO LATE

*wait for the objection*

#### ORDER

Pitch first → they object → you respond.

#### PROSPECT

"I'm too busy. Don't want more leads."

#### YOUR JOB

Try to talk them off the position they just took.

#### RESULT

Almost impossible. They're already defending it.

#### WHY

Verbal commitment to a stance = mental commitment to defending it.

### PRE-EMPT IT

*name it first, on your terms*

#### ORDER

You name the likely objection → frame it → dispose of it.

#### YOU SAY

"I know you don't want more leads — that's not what this is about."

#### YOUR JOB

Pick the framing yourself, on your terms.

#### RESULT

Prospect can't use that exit — you already addressed it.

#### WHY

The framing is yours, not theirs. You chose the rails.

## DRILL THIS WEEK

Before every pitch, write down the ONE objection this prospect is most likely to raise based on their business. Plan how to name it first. Block the exit before they see it.

# Mirror their language back

Take the prospect's exact words. Re-deliver them inside the wrapping of your product. They feel heard. The product feels custom-fit.

## THE RESTAURANT ANALOGY

A great waiter doesn't recite the menu. They ask what you like — chicken, beef, spicy, mild? — then repackage your answers inside their cuisine: "Perfect, our chicken dish is wonderful." You ordered yourself, with their flavour name attached. Sales works exactly the same way.

## FOUR WORKED EXAMPLES

THEY SAID

*"I want to blow up my business."*

YOU MIRROR

**"Perfect — here's our growth-focused package. We blow your phone up."**

THEY SAID

*"I want to stay the size I am."*

YOU MIRROR

**"Perfect — this is a maintenance package, not a growth lever. We protect what you've built."**

THEY SAID

*"I just want to look professional."*

YOU MIRROR

**"Perfect — let's talk about your website as your best salesperson when you're asleep."**

THEY SAID

*"Just a few extra leads would be good."*

YOU MIRROR

**"Perfect — we're adding an insurance layer that catches the leads you're currently missing."**

## WHY IT WORKS

The customer feels heard (you used their words). The product feels custom (it's described in their terms). And you did very little original sales work — you repackaged their brief.

# The 90 / 10 / 1 conversation ratio

A closing call should feel like a conversation, not an interrogation. Here's the ratio that gets you there.

## 90%

### ABOUT THE PROSPECT

Their business. Their last three jobs. Their concerns. Their goals. Their team. Their schools, their cars, their kids. You ask. They talk. You note. You ask another. This is where rapport, trust, and product fit are all built simultaneously.

## 10%

### ABOUT THE PRODUCT

Tailored from the 90%. The product described in their language.

## 1%

### ABOUT THE PRICE

Brief. Confident. Assumption frame already running.

### HOW TO MAKE QUESTION-EXTRACTION FEEL LIKE CONVERSATION

- Wrap fact-finding with curiosity, not clinical interest. “Just out of interest — what was your last job?”
- Reflect back what they said before asking the next question. Shows you were listening.
- Find one genuinely interesting thing in their answer. Explore it for a beat before moving on.
- Drop one small piece of yourself into the conversation. A comparable experience, a related story.
- Treat the prospect like a date you want a second one with — not a transaction to close.

### DIAGNOSTIC

If you finish a call and you did most of the talking — that's the call you just lost. Aim for the prospect doing 9 minutes for every 1 of yours.

# Connection is the master skill

Without connection, every script fails. With it, you can recover from almost any mistake.

## THE METAPHOR — UNIVERSAL ADAPTER

*A great salesperson is like a universal power adapter — they plug into any prospect, any culture, any context. They adapt to the customer's plug shape, not the other way around.*

## HOW PROSPECTS SPEAK BY CONNECTION LEVEL

### NO CONNECTION

*Polite. Generic. Ghosts you in a week.*

**“Yeah, sounds great. Let me think about it. I'll get back to you.”**

### WITH CONNECTION

*Specific. Honest. Closeable.*

**“It's a bit more than I wanted to spend — what can you do?”**

### NO CONNECTION

*Vague exit. No real next step.*

**“Send me some info. I'll be in touch.”**

### WITH CONNECTION

*Names the real blocker.*

**“Honestly, my partner controls the cash. Let me talk to them tonight.”**

## INSURANCE POLICY

Connection is your insurance policy. With it, you can say something slightly clumsy and still close — they like you, they forgive the misstep. Without it, every flaw is fatal.

# The assumption close + the frame break

Two micro-techniques that change the trajectory of a pitch. Drill both this week.

## THE ASSUMPTION CLOSE

Once the pitch lands, do NOT ask “are you interested?” or “would you like to proceed?” Assume the deal is happening and move straight to logistics.

### WHAT TO SAY

**“I’ll send you the link. All I need is a \$400 deposit. Any day that works best for your kick-off call with our project manager?”**

## WHY IT WORKS

- The hard part of the meeting is done. Asking “proceed?” re-opens closed questions.
- Customers who want the product also want the meeting to end. Let them get to lunch.
- If they want to apply brakes, they will. Making them brake is harder than letting them drift to yes.
- Default of the conversation should be yes — anything else is them actively pulling out.

## BREAKING THE SALESPERSON FRAME

Prospect says “I’m just looking.” Most reps accept it and back off. Don’t. Disrupt the script.

### WHAT TO SAY

**“Funny way to feel.” [pause] “I just said hello — I have to or my boss gets angry. Seriously, anything I can help with, let me know. I’ll leave you to it.”**

## WHAT IT DOES

Disrupts their script. Gives them permission to NOT engage (which makes them want to). Positions you as human, not as quota. Conversation now runs on different rails.

# Daily mindset card

Read every morning before your first call. Print this page. Pin it to your monitor.

## TODAY'S QUESTION

# Did I open the book?

### CHECKLIST

Before any pitch, run the affordability formula. Service × \$100k or trade × \$100k × 3. Open the book.

### BLOCK EXITS

Before they take a position, name their likely objection and frame it on your terms.

### MIRROR

Use their exact words. Repackage their goal inside your product. Don't invent — repackage.

### 90/10/1

90% about them. 10% the product. 1% the price. If you're monologuing, you're losing.

### CONNECTION

Build it before you pitch. With connection, every script works. Without it, every script fails.

***The book has the answers. Open the book.***

— Corie Dawson